

HASHKAMA WEEKLY

פרשת אחרי-קדושים
ז' אייר תשפ"ו
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By Reb Gemini חכמה ב-א תאמין?

Consider the following "Torah" thought, generated by Gemini:
Did the AI get it right? Do you find

it to be accurate? Or did the technology miss the boat?

Morai veRabbos, as we sit here reading the weekly bulletin instead of looking inside a Siddur, let us analyze a fascinating juxtaposition in Parshas Acharei-Kedoshim. In Acharei Mos, the Torah describes the Avodah of Yom Kippur, specifically the Seir La'Azazel (Vayikra 16:22). The Kohen Gadol places his hands on the Seir and confesses all the Aveiros of Klal Yisroel, effectively transferring our collective Chataim onto a farm animal before sending it off to the Midbar. It is the ultimate dream of every Litvish Baal Habayis: the absolute ability to outsource your Ruchniyus deficiencies directly to an independent contractor. We spend all year accumulating a massive backlog of Psheshos, and instead of engaging in exhausting Cheshbon Hanefesh, we just pack it all onto a goat. The Rambam (Hilchos Teshuva 1:2) emphasizes that this Viduy on the Seir was absolutely essential for the Kapparah of the Tzibbur. It sounds like the perfect system. If you accidentally burn the Cholent, forget to pay your expensive Shul membership dues, or talk loudly during Chazaras HaShatz, you just blame the Seir. The goat takes the ultimate fall, and you walk away entirely Patur. It is a brilliant strategy for avoiding Achrayus.

However, just as we get incredibly comfortable with this highly convenient arrangement, we read Parshas Kedoshim, which immediately destroys our entire strategy of avoiding Achrayus. In Kedoshim, we encounter the Issur of Lifnei Iver Lo Siten Michshol (Vayikra 19:14). Rashi (Vayikra 19:14) famously explains that this is not just about a physical Michshol, but giving an Eitzah She'einah Hogenes to someone who is an Iver BaDavar. Suddenly, the Torah pivots from a convenient system where we project our own Aveiros onto a Seir, to a strict system where we are hyper-responsible for making sure nobody else commits an Aveirah! If Acharei Mos is about exporting our own problems, Kedoshim is about importing everyone else's. We cannot just dump our personal issues on a Seir La'Azazel and walk away. We have to actively ensure that our beloved fellow Yid does not stumble in his Avodas Hashem. The connection between the two Parshiyos is a profound Mussar Haskel: the Seir La'Azazel is a one-time miracle for Kapparah, not a daily Hashkafa. You cannot live your entire life expecting a goat to fix your Middos. When the Seir is gone, you are left in the Midbar of your own Kehilla, where you are suddenly entirely responsible for the Michshol you create for the Tzibbur.

The **practical takeaway** from this dual Parsha experience is to stop living your daily life like you are constantly looking for a Seir La'Azazel. The next time there is a massive Machlokes at the local Kiddush club over who gets the last hot piece of Yapchik, do not look for a goat to blame for your behavior. Own your actions. Furthermore, look out for the Iver in your own Shul. If you see the Gabbai desperately struggling to find a tenth man for Mincha, do not just slip out the side door and create a Michshol for the Minyan. Take the Achrayus entirely upon yourself. We are commanded to be Kedoshim, and Kedushah does not come from outsourcing our daily Aveiros to livestock; it comes from ensuring we do not trip up our fellow Yid on his way to the Amud.

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Shabbus Zmanim

Chestnut Ridge, NY

2:30 pm	מנחה
6:20/7:28 pm	הדלקה (Early/Late)
--- pm	מנחה - קבלת שבת
7:46 pm	שקיעה
4:31/4:50 am	עלות השחר (16.1/72)
6:02 am	נץ החמה
7:15 am	שחרית
Hot kiddush & Shiur after davening	
8:52/9:28 am	סיור קריאת שמע
10:13/10:37 am	סיור תפילה
12:54 pm	חצות היום
1:29 pm	מנחה גדולה (30)
4:55 pm	מנחה קטנה (גר"א)
6:21 pm	פלג המנחה (גר"א)
--- pm	מנחה
7:47 pm	שקיעה
8:23/8:37 pm	צה"כ ר' משה (8.5/50)
8:39 pm	מעריב (52)
8:47/8:59 pm	צה"כ (60/72)



Next Week's Zmanim

Chestnut Ridge, NY

2:30 pm	מנחה
6:26/7:35 pm	הדלקה (Early/Late)
7:53 pm	שקיעה
7:15 am	שחרית
7:54 pm	שקיעה
8:46 pm	מעריב (52)

This Week's Riddle

Riddle: In this parsha, which two countries appear in the same pasuk?

Answer: Egypt and Canaan appear in a single pasuk, as we are commanded not to copy their actions (Vayikra 18:3).



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משל ונמשל ב-AI תאמין? By Reb Gemini

Consider the following "Torah" thought, generated by Gemini: Did the AI get it right? Do you find it to be accurate? Or did the technology miss the boat?

Mashal: Morai veRabbos, picture a typical Lakewood Yungerman who finally leaves the safe confines of the Beis Medrash for a highly lucrative job at a massive real estate syndicate owned by an incredibly demanding and powerful Gevir. This CEO has a list of very strict corporate Takanos, the absolute most severe being that nobody, under any circumstances, may ever park in his executive spot located right next to the entrance. The penalty is immediate termination and probably having your Shidduch resume retroactively blacklisted. Our Yungerman, Reb Chatzkel, works under a regional manager who commands absolute, unquestioning obedience. One freezing Tuesday during a torrential downpour, the manager hands Chatzkel the company minivan keys. "Chatzkel," he barks, "go pick up my hot pastrami sandwich, and when you get back, park right in the CEO's spot so the bread doesn't get soggy." Chatzkel is instantly trapped in a terrifying Machlokes. His supervisor, whose favor dictates his yearly bonus, gives a direct P'sak to park there. But the CEO's ultimate Takanah expressly forbids it. Disobey the manager, he is fired. Disobey the CEO, he is fired even faster. It is the classic corporate double-bind, perfectly engineered to give a Litvish Jew a stress-induced ulcer. Does he follow the immediate authority screaming about pastrami, or adhere to the ultimate authority of the founder? **Nimshal:** This precise dilemma is the foundation of a fascinating Halachic principle found in Parshas Kedoshim. The Pasuk states, "Ish Imo V'Aviv Tira'u V'es Shabtosai Tishmoru" (Vayikra 19:3). The Torah places the Mitzvah of Morah Av Va'Em—the absolute requirement to revere one's parents—right next to the Mitzvah of Shemiras Shabbos. Rashi (Vayikra 19:3), quoting the Gemara (Yevamos 5b), explains this juxtaposition with a crucial caveat: if your parent commands you to be Mechalel Shabbos, you must flatly refuse. Why? Because "Ata V'Avicha Chayavim B'Kavodi." You and your father are both obligated in the Kavod of the Ribbono Shel Olam. The Ribbono Shel Olam is the ultimate CEO, and your parents are the highly respected regional managers. The Gemara (Kiddushin 30b) tells us Hashem equates the Kavod of parents to His own Kavod, making it a remarkably serious Chiyuv. You must listen when parents demand you wear a heavy sweater because they are cold, or when they insist you stop tapping your fingers during Chazaras HaShatz. But the very moment the regional manager's directive contradicts the CEO's explicit Takanah—whether it involves breaking Shabbos, eating without a reliable Hechsher, or speaking Lashon Hara—the hierarchy is instantly resolved. The CEO's rules trump the manager's pastrami sandwich every single time. It is a stark reminder that while we must have immense Hakaras Hatov for the people who raised us, our ultimate allegiance belongs strictly to the Shulchan Aruch.

Practical Takeaway: The practical takeaway from this fundamental Yesod is recognizing exactly where our ultimate loyalty lies when navigating the endless social and familial pressures of the Frum world. We spend an exorbitant amount of time worrying about what our parents, our Shver, or the local Machmacher will think of our personal Hashkafic choices. We are constantly terrified of offending the regional managers of our lives. But Parshas Kedoshim demands crystal clear priorities. When a well-meaning relative insists you join a Halachically problematic business venture, or demands you attend a Simcha that completely violates your standards of Tznius, you must channel your inner Reb Chatzkel. You must respectfully but firmly remember that "Ata V'Avicha Chayavim B'Kavodi." You do not need to be a Chutzpan; you can politely decline the request with the absolute utmost Derech Eretz and Kavod. But you absolutely cannot violate the Ribbono Shel Olam's Takanos just to keep the peace at the Sunday morning family breakfast. Our highest obligation is to the ultimate CEO. So, the next time you are handed the keys and told to park in the forbidden spot, have the Halachic courage to park down the block, walk in the freezing rain, and let the sandwich get a little soggy. Your Ruchniyus is worth infinitely more than a dry piece of pastrami.

GOOD SHABBUS!